

HTTP ARCHIVE ANALYSIS

State of the Web 2020– 2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

Data Source: HTTP Archive · Jan 2020 – Mar 2026



Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Desktop crawls jumped from ~5M URLs in Jan 2020 to ~16M by mid-2023. Mobile grew from ~3.5M to ~12.5M over the same period, with a sharp inflection around mid-2022.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

~2,000 KB

DESKTOP MEDIAN

~1,900 KB

MOBILE MEDIAN

▲ ~25%

5-YEAR GROWTH



Desktop median rose from **~1,600 KB** in early 2020. The 75th-percentile desktop page now exceeds **4,000 KB**, indicating a long tail of heavy pages.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

76

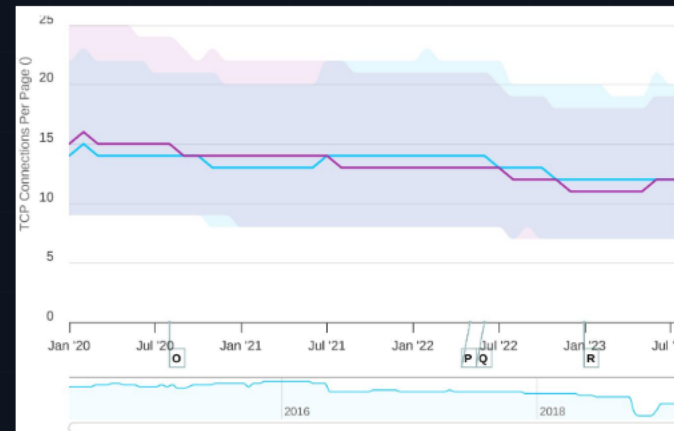
DESKTOP REQUESTS (MEDIAN)

▲ 2.7%

71

MOBILE REQUESTS (MEDIAN)

▲ 2.9%



Despite more requests, **TCP connections fell** from ~15 to ~12 (desktop) and ~15 to 11 (mobile) — a ▼ **14—27%** decline driven by HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99%+

99.2%

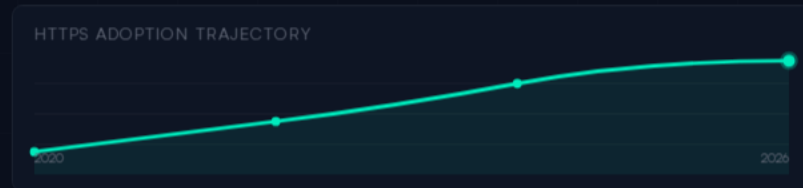
DESKTOP

99.1%

MOBILE

~80% → 99%

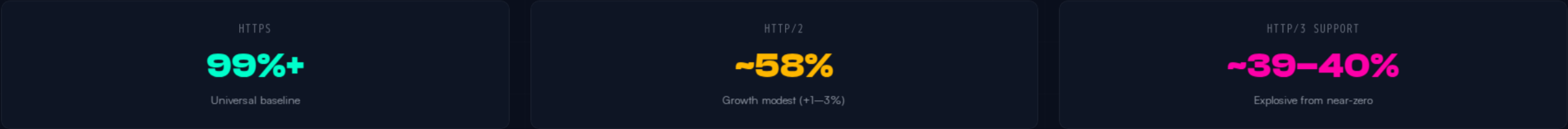
2020 TO 2026



An increase of roughly **19–20 percentage points** since early 2020. Unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web.



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%



PROTOCOL METRIC	DESKTOP	MOBILE
HTTPS Requests	99.2%	99.1%
HTTP/2 Requests	58.6%	57.6%
HTTP/3 Support	38.7%	40.0%

Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage because fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 capability via Alt-Svc headers.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

40.1%

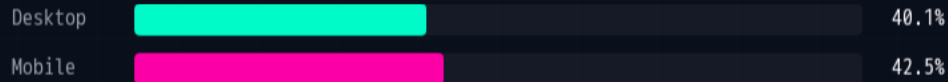
DESKTOP PAGES

▲ 14.9%

42.5%

MOBILE PAGES

▲ 61.0%



The `font-display` CSS property helps avoid the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during web font loading. While adoption is growing, **more than half of pages still risk FOIT.**



Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- 1 Page weight keeps climbing.** Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.
- 2 HTTPS is the new baseline.** At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.
- 3 HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric.** From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.
- 4 Fewer TCP connections despite more requests.** Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15—27%, improving network efficiency.
- 5 Font-display still underused.** At ~40—42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

CALL TO ACTION

Benchmark your own sites against these HTTP Archive baselines. Prioritize protocol upgrades, monitor page weight growth, and audit font-display coverage to stay ahead of the curve.

